

20 Early years

In English, the word “did” can be used for emphasis to assure someone that a past action really happened. It’s useful for describing past events and memories.

⚙️ **New language** “Did” for emphasis

Aa **Vocabulary** Baby equipment and parenting

🧩 **New skill** Describing your childhood

20.1 KEY LANGUAGE PAST SIMPLE WITH EMPHASIS

To emphasize a verb in the past simple, replace it with “did” plus the base form of the verb.

Past simple.

You **called** your dad about babysitting Kim tonight, didn’t you?



The word “did” gives emphasis.

“Did” is followed by the base form of the main verb.

No, but I **did call** Aunt Sue. She’ll be here soon.



20.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES PAST SIMPLE WITH EMPHASIS

I thought you **asked** Maya to put away these toys.



I **did ask** her. I think she forgot.

Are you sure you **bought** the birthday cake?



Yes, I **did buy** it. It’s on the top shelf.



20.3 REWRITE THE SENTENCES USING THE PAST SIMPLE WITH EMPHASIS

She worked hard at her homework.

She **did work hard** at her homework.

① I behaved well as a child.

② He took his lunchbox to school.

③ I enjoyed the children’s performance.

④ He gave his teacher a birthday card.

⑤ She played quietly at Anita’s house.

